

Zenith Premium Business PC

Compact and powerful

This is a compact workstation that uses an Intel 845 GV motherboard (with HyperThreading support), thus doing away with bulky expansion cards.

The mainboard comes with an onboard 4x AGP controller that can be allocated up to 64 MB of system memory. The onboard AC97 audio codec makes up the sound system. Also included is an integrated LAN controller and four USB 2.0 ports. The storage subsystem comprises a 40 GB hard disk, 1.44 MB FDD and 52x CD-ROM drive. All of this is housed inside a very classy silver and black case. However, this small case causes a ventilation problem. It brings along an OS of your choice, at extra cost and a lot of free software for Windows.

The ill-fitted side panel causes a prodigious amount of noise and the two-button



scroll mouse has a jerky scroll wheel. The multimedia keyboard includes a scroller.

The Zenith Premium Business PC, at Rs 65,000, is designed to be the pride of a CEO's desk.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium 4 3.06 GHz CPU with 533 MHz FSB and 512 KB cache, 256 MB DDR266 RAM, Intel 845GV motherboard, 40 GB, 7,200-rpm hard disk, onboard sound and graphics controllers, 52x CD-ROM drive, 1.44 MB floppy drive, Smart Office keyboard, scroll mouse, 15-inch CRT monitor, 180 watt stereo speakers

Zenith Premium Business PC		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Price: Rs 65,000
Contact: Zenith Computers Ltd
Phone: 022-8377300
Fax: 022-8364859
Web site: www.zenith-india.com

UMAX Astra4700

Scanning made easy

UMAX's Astra4700 is a high-performance flatbed scanner with a high optical resolution of 1200 dpi and 48-bit colour capability that lets you obtain sharper images. The scanner comes with a USB 2.0 connection for faster connections and wider bandwidth. It brings along a bundle of programs such as MGI's PhotoSuite III SE, Abbyy FineReader OCR and Paper-Com Document Manager.

It has three one-touch buttons that perform func-

tions such as e-mailing, and scanning and copying paper documents. The installation was pretty simple—it comes with a power adapter and USB cable, so you just need



to plug it in. We used a USB 1.1 enabled port for the test.

While the manual states that you just need to run the installation CD for acceptance by Windows XP, upon doing so, we found out that the TWAIN button was not highlighted. According to the manual, this

is natural as XP installs the drivers automatically, but the scanner was not present in the installed devices list. Finally we had to go to the Drivers folder on the CD and install the driver manually.

We scanned the test 8x10 text document in black and white mode at 600 dpi in 42 seconds. A colour photograph was scanned at 600 dpi and 48-bit colour in 4 minutes 6 seconds. The same image was then scanned in the greyscale mode at 16 bits and 600 dpi resolution in 1 minute

34 seconds. A true USB 2.0 interface will cut down the time taken by these tests. The same image was scanned at 300 dpi and at 600 dpi resolution with 85 per cent accuracy.

The Astra4700 is a high-quality scanner, but Rs 11,950 is a steep price to pay, unless quality is your priority.

SPECIFICATIONS

Single-pass, colour-interlaced CCD scanner, 1200x2400 dpi optical resolution, maximum document size 8.5x11.7-inches, 48-bit colour depth, USB 2.0 interface, 16 watts power consumption

Price: Rs 11,950
Contact: Neoteric Informatique
Phone: 022-2417 2600
Fax: 022-2418 5294
E-mail: sales@neoteric-informatique.com
Web site: www.umax-europe.com

UMAX Astra4700		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Wipro LQ 5400 dot matrix printer

Bulk-printing workhorse

Wipro claims its LQ 5400 dot matrix printer to be the fastest in its category. Both serial as well as parallel interfaces have been provided at the back of this 24-pin, 136-column printer and the power cord has adequate reach.

You can feed paper from five different paths and the dual tractor enables two different kinds of paper to be loaded at the same time for efficiency. You can also choose the printer fonts and the pitch from the front panel, which is quite handy while operating in DOS.

A lever on the printer lets you print multiple copies at once—useful while printing bills, labels and reports. The printer is as noisy as any other dot matrix printer, but is very cost-efficient as its cartridge is



comparatively cheaper (approximately Rs 200) as compared to Inkjet printers. (Rs 700). The print quality is clear even with small fonts and is consistent throughout the page.

However, the printer is quite bulky and occupies a considerable amount of desk space. The drivers were shipped on a floppy drive, which is quite obsolete in these times.

SPECIFICATIONS

24 pins, 136 column, 450 cps printing speed, five paper paths with dual tractor, serial and parallel interface

Price: Rs 28,000
Contact: Wep Peripherals Ltd
Phone: 022- 26397418
Fax: 022-26397393
E-mail: helpdesk.mumbai@wepindia.com
Web site: www.wepindia.com

Wipro LQ 5400 dot matrix printer		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	